Supplemental Security Income (SSI) and State Supplementary Payment (SSP) Cost-of-Living Adjustment (COLA)	**Number**	**Page**
	CalFresh 26-01	1 of 2

Effective Date:
02/01/2026

Background:
SSI/SSP recipients received a COLA effective January 1, 2026.

Purpose:
SSI and SSP recipients receive a COLA Adjustment annually. This notice provides update and guidance on applying the 2026 COLA adjustment for initial applications and ongoing cases that failed the batch process.

Policy:
New Applicants
The actual amount of SSI/SSP benefits, including the COLA adjustment, must be used for eligibility and budgeting purposes. The SSI/SSP amount budgeted for January will be considered reasonably anticipated income for applications received in January 2026.

Ongoing Households (HHs)
SSI/SSP COLA updates are considered Verified Upon Receipt (VUR). The Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) conducts a data match against the California Statewide Automated Welfare System (CalSAWS) to produce a file with the updated SSI/SSP payment amounts due to the COLA adjustment. Based on the information received, SSI/SSP payment amounts were updated during the batch process on January 8, 2026.

Ongoing Transitional CalFresh (TCF) Cases
TCF cases containing an SSI/SSP recipient had their payment amounts automatically adjusted in CalSAWS on January 8, 2026. The new payment amounts must be counted in the budget at the end of the TCF certification period after the HH recertifies to regular CalFresh benefits.

Other Public Assistance Record Not Updated
The SSI-SSP Excluded Other Public Assistance Records Report will be generated monthly to assist in identifying cases with an Eligibility Status Report (SAR 7) or recertification due. This report will continue to be generated until all excluded cases have been reviewed and updated.

Based on the information received SSI/SSP payment amounts were updated accordingly:

If an SSI/SSP recipient's…	**then the payments were…**
eligible amount is less than or equal to the paid amount,	updated to the eligible amount automatically. Changes to the HH's benefit allotment will take effect February 2026.
paid amount is less than their eligible amount (or their SSI/SSP benefits could not be matched),	not updated in CalSAWS. Review and update the payment amounts at the next Eligibility Status Report (SAR 7) or recertification, whichever comes first.

A paid amount that is less than the eligible amount indicates a possible recoupment. The reason for the recoupment must be reviewed at the next SAR 7 or recertification, whichever comes first, and the SSI/SSP income must be included in the budget as follows:

If the recoupment is due to…	then use the following amount in the budget…
an SSI/SSP overpayment,	the paid amount.
any other reason,	the eligible amount.

Procedure:
The following case list reports along with instructions on action to take will be shared:

- Cases Excluded from SSI COLA.
- Programs Discontinued by the Batch EDBC Process.
- Cases Where Batch EDBC Process Closed a Person.
- Unprocessed Cases Where Batch EDBC Process Skipped a Program.
- SSI-SSP OPA Record Not Updated – this is sent as a monthly report.

References:
All County Information Notice (ACIN) I-74-22, I-74-22E, I-56-25.

Sunset Date:
12/31/2026

Approval for Release:



Alberto Banuelos, Ph. D., Interim Director
Self-Sufficiency Services